GUILLERMO BASTERRA

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EDUCATION

Cornell Tech, Cornell University — New York, NY
M.Eng. in Computer Science — Expected May 2027
Relevant Coursework: Deep Learning, Networks and Markets, Decentralized Finance, Trust and Safety

University of Southern California — Los Angeles, CA
B.S. in Computer Science, GPA: 3.51 — May 2026
Relevant Coursework: Operating Systems, Natural Language Processing, Web Search Engines, Theory of Computation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Prior Foundry (a16z Speedrun), Research Engineer (Part-time), Los Angeles, CA — Feb 2026 – May 2026
- Built a BigQuery-backed validation pipeline for an LLM policy-simulation platform, benchmarking survey-grounded agent populations against ~227K rows of real social-science outcomes (SimBench, SocSci210)
- Designed a confidence-scoring and profile-ablation harness quantifying which persona attributes drive each simulated decision, separating model signal from noise across agent runs
- Shipped the company's first CI/CD pipeline (GitHub Actions, Playwright), with a mocked LLM-API layer that tests worker timeouts and crashes offline, moving production deploys from manual SSH to push-to-main

Kantar, Applied AI Software Engineer — Digital Twins, London, UK — Jun 2025 – Sep 2025
- Co-built a Digital Twins platform simulating Fortune 500 consumer segments with LLM-driven personas, working in a 4-person Kantar team with 5 Microsoft engineers and piloting with 3 enterprise clients
- Designed and shipped an "AI reasoning report," a per-decision trace UI showing pilot clients why each simulated consumer chose what it did, answering the #1 trust objection from enterprise buyers

Pencil AI, Applied AI Software Engineer — Insights & Predictions, London, UK — Jun 2024 – Sep 2024
- Led the ABCD Detector, a Gemini-based video-ad evaluation tool built with Google's Creative Works and gTech teams
- Cut evaluation time per video by over 90% (7 min to 20–30 s) while holding 90% accuracy, using a multi-agent consensus protocol and targeted prompt-engineering heuristics

USC Center for AI in Society, Research Assistant, Los Angeles, CA — Jan 2023 – May 2023
- Built a data pipeline and LSTM/CNN models predicting wildfire occurrence and spread from geospatial data

PROJECTS

Agent Paywall Marketplace (Python, FastAPI, Stripe MPP, Connect, MCP) — Lead Engineer — Oct 2026 – Present
Cornell Tech Product Studio: a marketplace where AI agents pay writers per read for paywalled articles
- Building agent-to-writer payments on Stripe's Machine Payments Protocol: agents pay sub-cent reads against a session, writers get paid via Connect, and signed receipts license each read for citation and bar AI training
- Developing an MCP server that lets Claude find and buy articles mid-answer under a spend cap with human approval; scoped the product through user interviews, two pivots and pitch reviews with Product Studio advisors

Google DeepMind Mentorship (Python, TensorFlow) — Mentee — Jun 2022 – Sep 2022
- Selected as 1 of 4 mentees for a 3-month ML mentorship under a DeepMind research scientist

SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, C++
AI/ML: LLM evals, multi-agent systems, MCP, RAG, vector databases (ChromaDB, pgvector), Ollama, PyTorch
Backend & Infrastructure: FastAPI, Node.js, PostgreSQL, BigQuery, Docker, GCP (Cloud Run, Tasks), Azure, Linux
Frontend & Tools: React, Next.js, Pytest, Playwright, Git, code review, Claude Code
Spoken Languages: English, Spanish (native)